

YoungJoo Kang

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SUMMARY

AI Safety and Evaluation practitioner combining hands-on red-teaming, RLHF, and SFT experience with a 10+ year background in B2B enterprise operations. Specializes in assessing whether model outputs align with defined behavioral specifications, evaluating the reasoning behind each judgment rather than surface output compliance, and identifying structural gaps in evaluation guidelines. Leverages cross-cultural validation to map how safety judgments shift in unstructured environments, surfacing contextual vulnerabilities invisible to English-centric evaluation frameworks.

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH

Judgment Framework Research: Korean Speech Annotation Portfolio

Jun 2026

- Analyzed the judgment framework behind 10 annotation cases in Korean speech data, independently establishing decision criteria in areas where existing standards left boundaries undefined.
- Documented reasoning-layer edge cases and mapped their implications to Physical AI safety scenarios, building a domain-transferable methodology for judgment framework design.
- Identified three cross-case structural patterns (competency independence, framework-dependent consistency, and judgment-validation separation) that now serve as reusable principles for judgment framework design.

stop-bluff: Open-source Input Integrity Protocol for LLMs

Jun 2026

- Developed an open-source governance protocol to mitigate structural LLM vulnerabilities, specifically completion bias and sycophancy, preventing models from silently bypassing missing inputs or inferring undefined terms.
- Designed a strict four-part behavioral guardrail (Input Verification, Honesty Obligation, Confirmation Gate, Self-Contained Return) that forces the AI to halt processing and explicitly request user validation when data mismatches occur.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TOOLS

- **AI Safety & Governance:** Red Teaming, Adversarial Testing, LLM Evaluation (RLHF), SFT Data Annotation, Quality Governance, Prompt Engineering
- **Methodology & Frameworks:** Specification Framework Design, Multi-layered Rubric Application, Cross-cultural & Legal Context Analysis, Inter-annotator Calibration
- **Technical Tools:** Python (Foundational), Excel
- **Languages:** Korean (Native), English (Professional)

AI SAFETY & EVALUATION EXPERIENCE

Independent AI Safety & Data Annotation Contractor

Oct 2025 – Present

Mercor, Turing.com | Remote

Conducted AI training data annotation and evaluation across adversarial safety, reasoning integrity, and data governance, spanning Korean and English across multiple model types and task formats.

- **Safety Red-Teaming & Adversarial Evaluation** (Korean): Wrote and conducted adversarial test prompts across sensitive and harmful categories, targeting Korean-language-specific patterns and culturally embedded edge cases; advanced from RLHF evaluation to SFT-level response revision, editing model outputs to meet defined safety and quality standards.
- **Reasoning & Alignment Evaluation** (English): Evaluated AI-generated legal responses for reasoning integrity, identifying subtle logical flaws and misapplied legal principles across complex prompts.
- **Data Quality & Annotation Governance** (Korean): Annotated spontaneous multi-speaker conversational Korean audio for SFT; identified structural gaps in Korean language conventions and cross-lingual consistency, including honorific register mismatches and translationese syntax.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

APJ Enterprise Excellence Program Manager

Jan 2022 – Aug 2023

Amazon Web Services Korea | Seoul, Korea

- Designed and maintained enterprise account planning and customer journey frameworks across 50+ APJ accounts, mapping cross-functional engagement touchpoints to reduce customer fatigue and enable coordinated, one-voice go-to-market execution.
- Led opportunity review process across enterprise accounts, providing structured analysis of pipeline health and execution readiness to support sales decision-making.

Business Strategy & Operations Analyst

Feb 2019 – Dec 2021

VMware Korea | Seoul, Korea

- Designed and built the Account Potential Framework: a structured model for calculating each enterprise account's total addressable buying power using IT landscape data, employee count, device inventory, install-base, and competitive displacement estimates. Logic was cross-validated with relevant functional team leads and adopted by sales teams as the basis for account planning.
- Translated market signals, customer insights, and performance data into actionable guidance for sales and solution teams; maintained enterprise dashboards and planning tools to support real-time performance tracking across regional stakeholders.

Business Strategy & Operations Analyst

Apr 2018 – Feb 2019

Oracle Korea | Seoul, Korea

- Supported APAC channel leadership with structured partner performance tracking, compliance monitoring, and engagement planning. Translating performance data into actionable inputs for regional partner strategy.

Inside Sales Representative

Sep 2013 – Apr 2018

Oracle Korea | Seoul, Korea

- Managed full SMB sales cycle for cloud-based solutions: account segmentation by size and upsell potential, campaign-driven pipeline development using install-base and marketing data, and co-selling coordination with Field Sales Representatives.
- Achieved Annual Quota Attainment across multiple years within a shared-territory model, supporting field sales logistics and internal approval processes alongside direct pipeline development.

Solution Sales Associate

Sep 2010 – Apr 2013

Futures Brain Co., Ltd | Seoul, Korea

- Built cross-border partnerships and guided clients on compliance and localization requirements for IT-financial product integration.

Sales & Marketing Associate

Jan 2008 – Jul 2009

Korea Exchange Bank Futures | Seoul, Korea

- Promoted derivative financial products and managed private investor relationships; supported marketing and PR for client-facing events.

EDUCATION

LL.M. in International Legal Studies

Aug 2009 – May 2010

American University Washington College of Law | Washington D.C., USA

- Embassy of the Republic of Korea & PILPG: researched U.S. congressional foreign policy and post-conflict peace building during LL.M. year.

LL.M. coursework in International Law

Aug 2008 – Aug 2009

Yonsei University Graduate School of Law | Seoul, Korea

B.A. in International Studies

Mar 2004 – Feb 2008

Korea University, Division of International Studies | Seoul, Korea

CERTIFICATIONS

Google AI Essentials · Google Career Certificate

Nov 2025

ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers · DeepLearning.AI & OpenAI

Aug 2025